



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2023 Version B for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05340) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2023**

Courses Audience: **59**

Responses Received: **31**

Response Ratio: **52.5%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

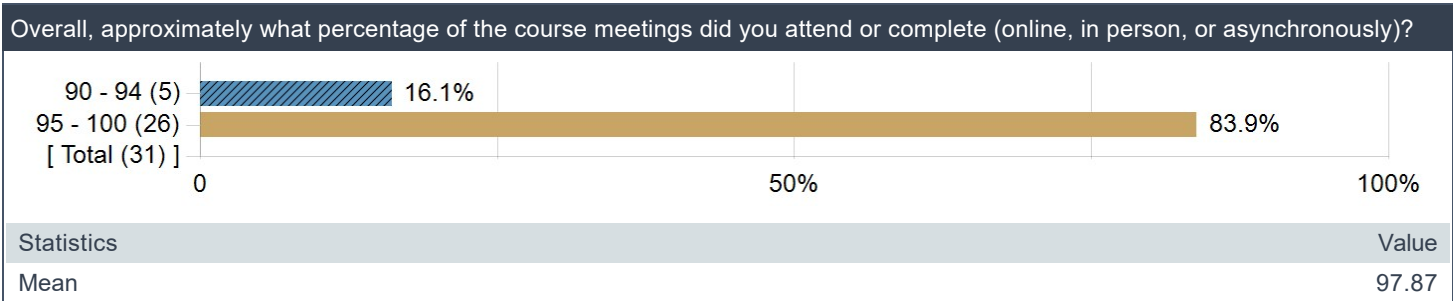
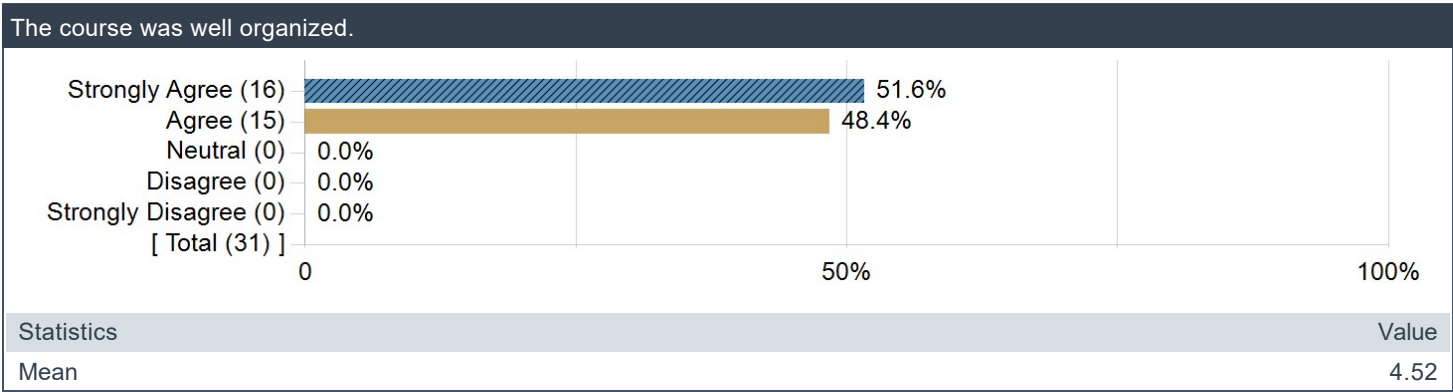
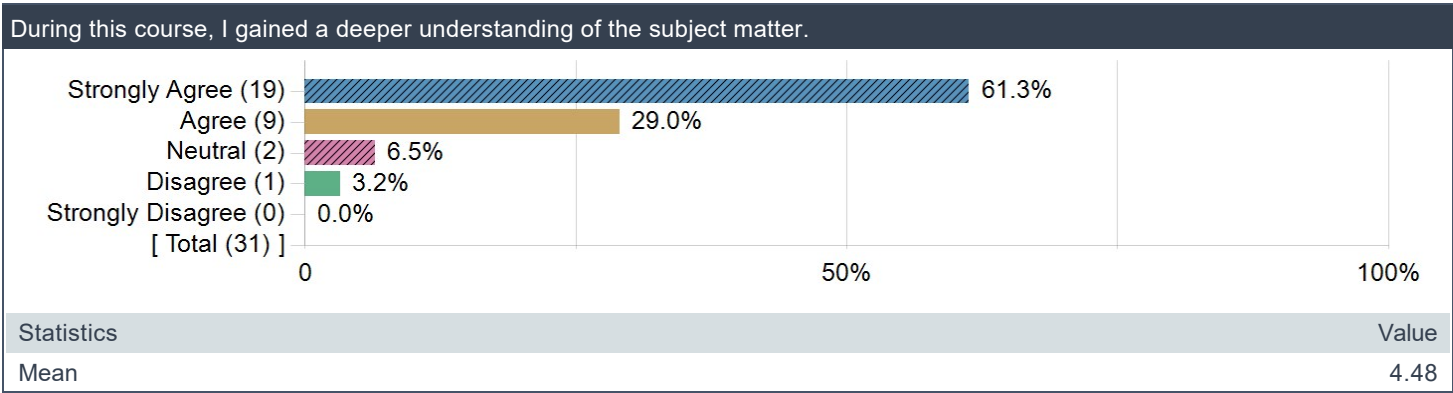
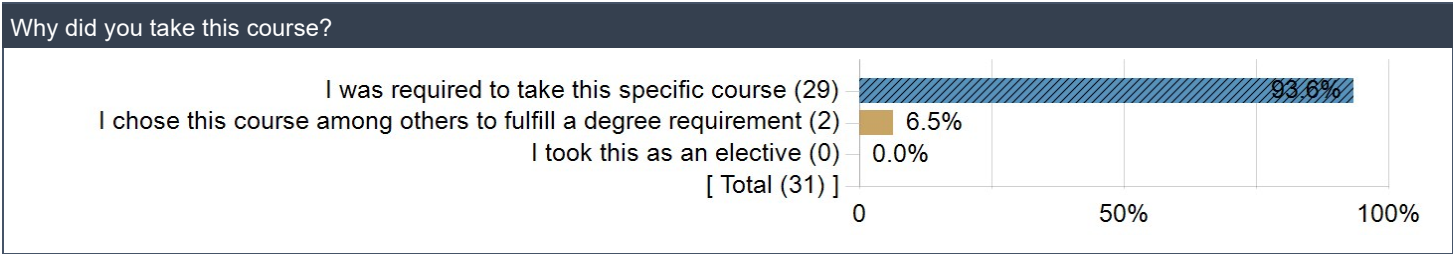
The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

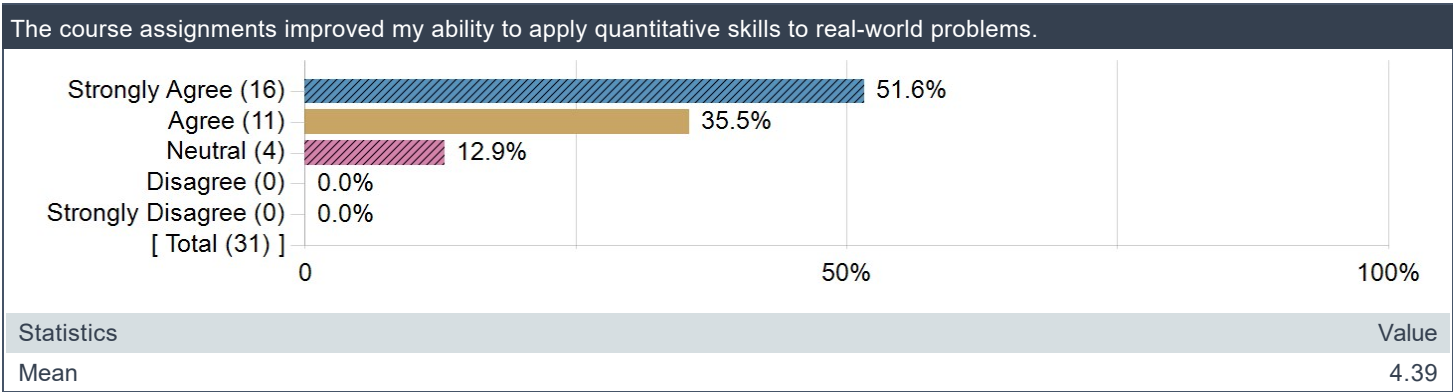
Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

Creation Date: **Sunday, January 21, 2024**

Course Questions



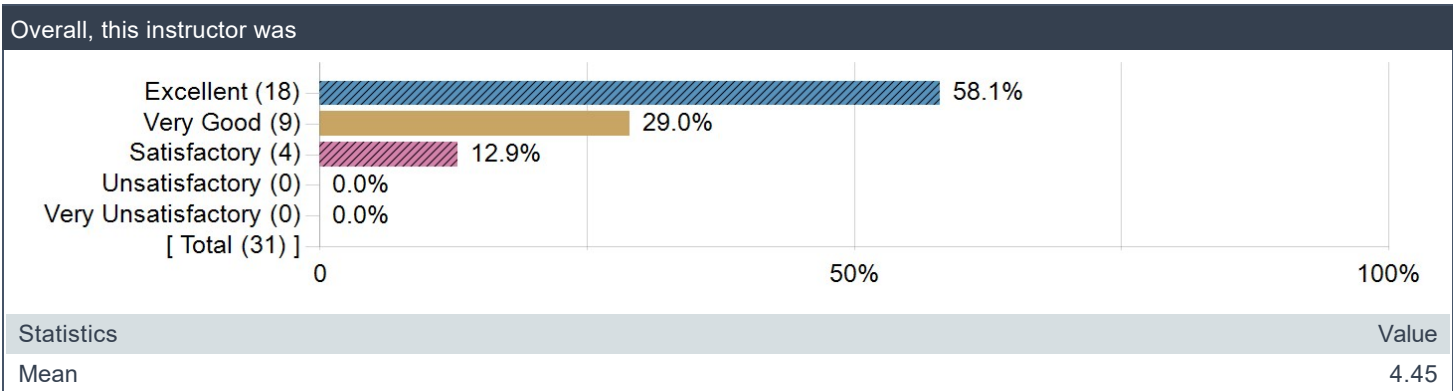
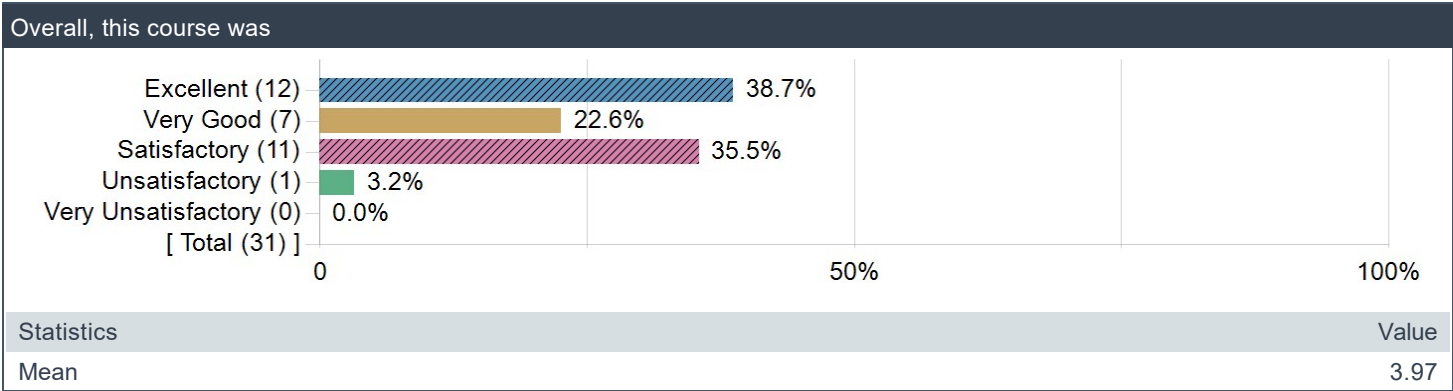
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



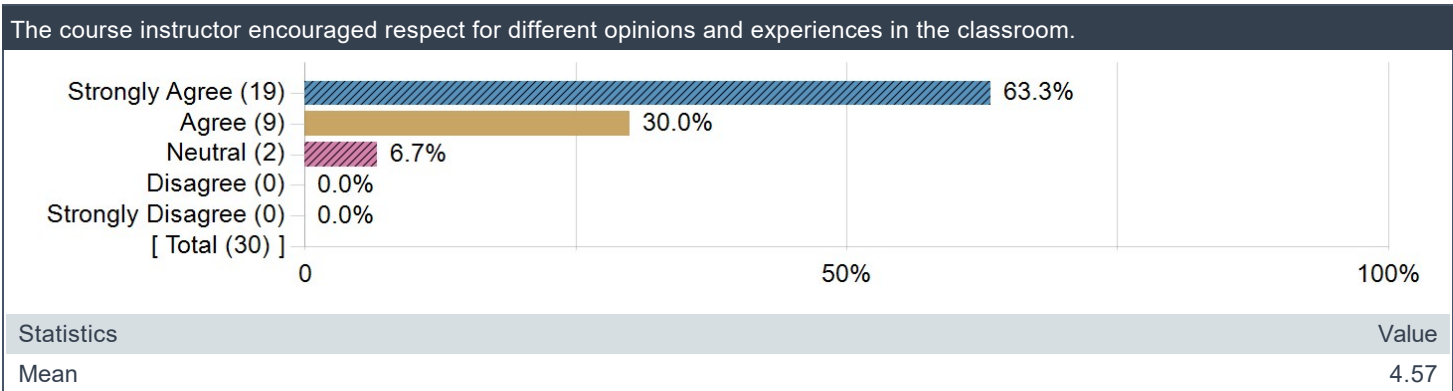
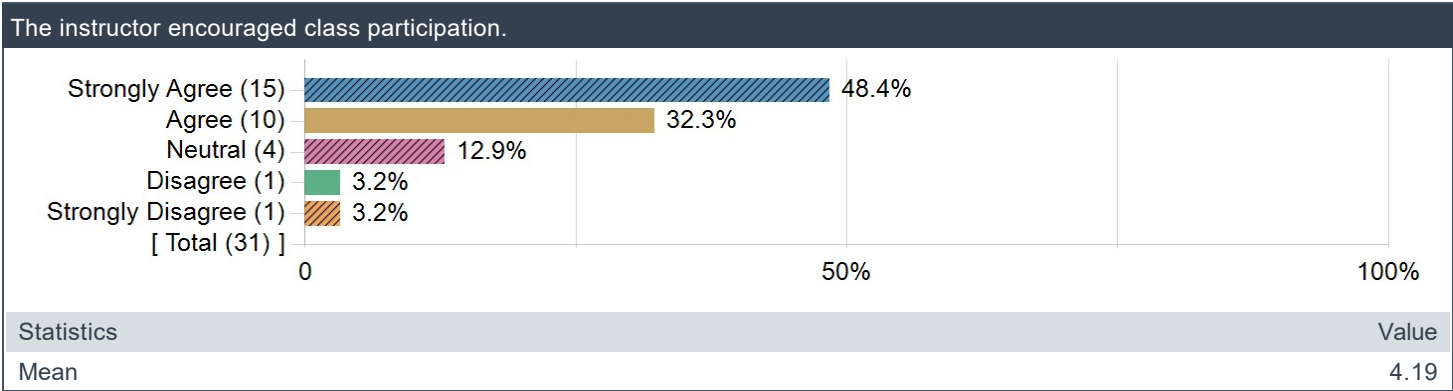
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	51.6%	38.7%	9.7%	0.0%	0.0%	31	4.42
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	71.0%	22.6%	6.5%	0.0%	0.0%	31	4.65
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	51.6%	38.7%	6.5%	3.2%	0.0%	31	4.39
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	48.4%	32.3%	6.5%	6.5%	6.5%	31	4.10
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	67.7%	25.8%	3.2%	3.2%	0.0%	31	4.58

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
R sessions and study resources
I liked his style of teaching and trying to personify the concepts into a more common situation in order to help us understand.
displays the exact information he is coding so we can replicate
I like the engagingness of the course
Coding with the professor in class
He explained things thoroughly
Professor Bolfarine was super understanding of the topic and helped us a lot in the course. He was super open to answering questions as well.
The aspect of the course that was most effective in helping me learn was how engaging the professor was throughout the lectures and how he was always eager to answer any questions or concerns that we had.
expalning
I think he is a great teacher. He is always in a good mood and makes for an awesome learning environment. I'm not sure I would have been able to get through the course had he not been my teacher.
The KC assignments were very effective in reinforcing the material. The course was outlined well and the course expectations were very clear.
The textbook and office hours were without a doubt the most effective in helping me learn because they were key to breaking down concepts and evaluate my mistakes and successes in my processing.
He helped ease our anxiety for major grades and walked us through reviewing the problems making sure we are going to be okay! very good professor caring for his students.
the R sessions
the knowledge checks were very helpful towards learning
The constant use of homework and examples in class was very good for grasping the material.
Very well structured and detailed outlines to expected work to be completed before class, detailed and step-by-step content coverage with lots of practical examples, regular reminder for upcoming assignments, and long periods for assignments to be available and completed
Having the textbook as a resource to reference was very helpful in the case that I did not understand a topic the first time in class.
Every assignment had a reasonable due date, well organized.
In class learning
On the KC having multiple attempts to get the right answer encouraged me to do the work and feel better and more confident about doing the problems, it allowed me to learn until I reached the correct answer.
The slides were super helpful when learning.
How the class was set up made it very easy to learn and apply the information we were learning.
Homeworks because they put all the concepts together
reading textbook
Doing in class participation

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
in class instruction lacks engagement
Sometimes he spread misinformation about the midterm which was frustrating. I believe that there was miscommunication between whoever had wrote the test and him, I hope in the future that the department is all on the same page before instructing students on what concepts are and aren't on exams.
examples in class often much easier than on hw so trying to do hw can be a bit of a struggle lol
Trying to learn R
Retaining information, I took a step back after the midterm and got more bored in class. Try to highlight after the midterm to students to keep working hard and make those lectures more interesting
It was hard to stay engaged in lecture. Something that could be done i the future would be having the class move at a faster pace.
The memorization of the different functions and code. Definitely read the textbook as it explains R more in depth and the syntax/how each function works.
The aspect of the course that I found the most challenging is having to learn how to code and how fast paced the course. We would learn a new concept every class period and I feel like it just wasn't enough time in between for students to be able to fully grasp one topic. Considering the fact that the coursework is already challenging enough, I just felt like concepts were constantly getting introduced so there was no time to fully understand the previous content.
n/a
Simply the course and its material was hard for me to understand. I feel that there is nothing that could have been different.
The most challenging part was the peer grading. Sometimes students would knock off random points without explanation, while other times people would just give full scores. In the future, I would recommend making the grading rubric a bit clearer.
The exams were the most challenging part despite the preparation and notice. To counter this, I would suggest to continue the exam practices along with having knowledge checks based on past concepts to keep those concepts fresh.
I would probably want a printed out copy of all the codes I need to use or how to use them, it would have been helpful. The homeworks are a bit tedious, and long.
coding in general, application
sometimes the instructor wasn't entirelyly comprehensive about what was going to be on the tests, but it was mostly fine
I found the Homework assignments most challenging due to to time it took to complete and the self-driven aspect. I think nothing is needed to improve this as it was a healthy amount of difficulty and representative of the course.
The professor was sometimes unsure about himself, leading me to be confused as well. His uncertainty about the subject matter does not help me learn with confidence.
His way of teaching was very confusing, he would contradict himself a lot. Nothing too crazy though.
the homeworks and exams
The course material as a whole was challenging, and I don't know if theres anything that can be done
The homework write ups were challenging but the TAs were always super helpful.
knowledge checks
Knowing the different concepts